Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From a memoir by a civil rights activist reflecting on the impact of the Fair Housing Act (Civil Rights Act of 1968), published in 1980.

We thought the Fair Housing Act of 1968 would change everything. It was signed into law during the national grief after Dr. King's assassination. But passing a law is not the same as enforcing it. Real estate agents still used redlining, banks refused mortgages to Black families, and local school boards gerrymandered school zones to keep classrooms segregated. By 1975, the suburbs remained almost entirely white, while our people remained trapped in underfunded inner-city schools.

Source C

Source C: From a report by the US Department of Justice on the enforcement of civil rights legislation, published in 1974.

Significant progress has been achieved in political representation and legal desegregation. The Voting Rights Act has registered millions of Black voters, resulting in a fivefold increase in Black elected officials in the South by 1974. However, the Department faces severe challenges in enforcing the Fair Housing Act. Informal practices of discrimination in rental markets and local resistance to busing for school integration continue to prevent complete equality, showing that de facto segregation is highly resistant to federal litigation.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
By 1975, the civil rights movement had hit a wall of economic and social resistance. The legal gains of the mid-1960s did little to improve the lives of the urban poor. Inner-city schools remained segregated in practice, unemployment among Black youths was twice that of white youths, and the Kerner Commission's warnings of two separate societies went unheeded. The movement succeeded in ending legal segregation in the South, but it failed to conquer the economic division of the nation.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
The decade after 1965 witnessed a profound transformation in Black political and social status. Under the pressure of federal legislation, Black registration and voting surged, leading to the election of thousands of Black mayors, congressmen, and officials. Furthermore, affirmative action policies opened up higher education and white-collar employment. While economic inequality was not eliminated, the progress made by 1975 was substantial and irreversible.

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